RESEARCH STATEMENT | Naman Gupta

My research goal is to make technology safer for *every* individual. Modern digital technologies have become integral to society, but they also perpetuate harms: platforms, devices, algorithms, and infrastructure are weaponized by adversaries to create safety challenges for users. However, conventional safety mechanisms like encryption, blocking, and banning fail to protect the most vulnerable victims. Classical threat models overlook adversaries who are linked with victim through a relationship, physical proximity, social identity, and power dynamics. My work situates interpersonal violence (stalking through AirTags or AI-generated nudes) in the broader structural violence (genocide through criminal databases, AMBER alerts) by centering the underlying assertion of power and control dynamic, albeit at different scales. Globally, 1 in 3 women [1] and in US, 1 in 2 transgender [2] people experience physical, sexual, psychological intimate partner violence (IPV). Exposure to violence takes away power and agency resulting in traumatic impacts (health inequities, censored cultural expression, economic dependence, etc.). Initiatives such as tech clinics and privacy education play a crucial role in restoring power and agency to survivors, however, their limited availability and scale is insufficient to prevent violence at scale. To mitigate and end repeated pattern of violence, "safety" must stem from peoples' needs, agency, and flourishing; moving their life state from survival to thriving through interventions.

To do this, I combine ethnographic, participatory, and design methods to study how technologies perpetuates gender-based violence (GBV) such as intimate partner violence, labor/sex trafficking, genocide, and environmental destruction. Specifically, how **equitable sociotechnical interventions (trainings, tools, and advocacy practices) and research practices (methods, data, and design practices) can reduce and prevent harm among communities, helping them foster healing and safety**. I make contributions across two threads:

1. **Interventions to support GBV survivors and frontline providers:** I have designed interventions to develop confidence and capacity among GBV survivors and more than 200 frontline providers. These interventions are currently deployed in practice through Madison Tech Clinic (MTC). I built an educational intervention for providers towards early detection, mitigation, and prevention of violence [In-review CSCW 2027]. Addressing survivor needs, I have built tools and advocacy practices to help collect and preserve evidence for legal injunctions [CSCW 2025, CHI 2026, CCS 2025, In-review USENIX 2027]. These interventions build on measurement of the prevalence of GBV in college contexts [CHI 2024] and characterization of survivors' support-seeking strategies and challenges faced before they reach out to frontline GBV providers [USENIX 2024, NDSS 2024].
2. **Research praxis to surface and liberate from structural violence:** Equitable interventions require studying violence at an intimate level; however, studying violence itself may reproduce more harm. I have created safe and culturally-sensitive methods, data, and design practices to support marginalized communities. I do this by studying how the history of colonial violence perpetuate through infrastructure (criminal databases, AMBER alerts, AI data centers) to violate Indigenous communities, epistemology, and land [In-review CSCW 2027]. Importantly, my work centers how communities resist, refuse, reclaim, and build new infrastructure for care, sovereignty, and liberation.

In the next several years, I will expand these two threads of research with a focus on emerging technologies (wearables, alert systems, AI generated content) to characterize the harms they pose to various communities. Then, I will use community-engaged methods to envision interventions for mitigating and preventing violence.

Research Process. Despite being experts in lived knowledge, GBV survivors and frontline providers (health practitioners, legal justice workers, and policymakers) are often overburdened, under-compensated, taken advantage of by academics, and epistemically underrepresented; all of which limit their participation in research. Thus, I collaborate with providers by building strong relationships to understand their pressing issues, structural forces that impact their technology use and safety needs. With these insights, I develop research questions that can inform the most impactful interventions and steps towards prevention. Such an immersive engagement is essential to reduce the reflexive distance, which would otherwise not be possible through sources such as online forums, task workers, or AI agents. Then, I use diverse methods to collect data through interviews, surveys, content analysis, and auto/ethnography. I invite providers to share their experiences by co-constructing a safe space with care and tenderness, by embodying trauma-informed care, reciprocity, and cultural sensitivity. I analyze their data through analytical approaches rooted in feminist, decolonial, and Indigenous onto-epistemology. In fact, I utilize the "Upstream Story" [12] framework (Figure 1) to build transformative interventions that can (a) fulfill providers' immediate needs, (b) reduce harm and build capacity that enables providers to detect violence early or prevent it in the first place. Then, I work with the providers to iterate on the intervention design and assess their effectiveness in practice. Finally, I reciprocate my research by disseminating knowledge back to communities through talks, panels, and workshops at cross-disciplinary policy, law, and healthcare venues. Overall, this research process is slow, intentional, and challenging: emotional, traumatic, time-consuming, and logistically complex with high-stakes impact on providers' life, especially with current academic uncertainties and planetary crises. It requires a thorough understanding of theories of change across disciplines and epistemology to build liberatory and sustainable interventions.

1. Interventions to Support GBV Survivors and Frontline Providers. To measure the scope and impact of interpersonal tech violence, it is crucial to understand the statistics of the most and least frequent tech violence experiences and coping strategies. Using college campuses as one such context, I studied [CHI 2024] the prevalence of tech violence and

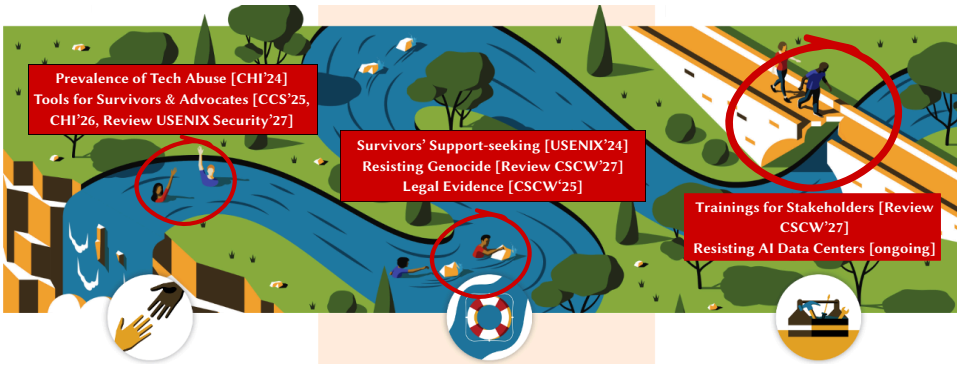


Figure 1: My work focuses on each part of the stream to effectively prevent violence by building interventions (a) downstream to support survivors' immediate needs after the abuse has occurred, (b) midstream to support survivors' coping strategies to mitigate abuse, and (c) upstream to prevent survivors from falling into the river.

support strategies, through a survey of 776 college students. Alarmingly, 70% of students experienced such experiences: 60% faced unwanted calls and messages, 51% non-consensual sharing of intimate images/videos or messages. Also, women (2x) and LGBTQ+ (3x) students were more likely to face violence than men, showing that tech violence is a gendered issue. Importantly, more than half of students (53%) did not seek support. When they did, most students (93%) solely relied on informal systems like friends and family, and only 6% solely sought formal systems. These statistics are essential for directing appropriate health resources and guiding policy interventions. The prevalence study, however, does not explain *why* survivors do not seek support and what happens when they do. To understand this, I interviewed nine survivors to examine their experiences in seeking support from their community and the effectiveness of support in addressing their safety needs. This study [USENIX 2024] underlined the barriers that impeded the survivors from seeking informal an and formal support and the challenges they face before they even reach out to GBV frontline providers. Survivors are often disbelieved and provided with an ineffective advocate to mitigate abuse due to a lack of adequate resources. Moreover, providers use unsafe technological mediums to communicate, which is especially challenging when abusers often isolate them or escalate violence. Our findings revealed how survivors, despite not being technical experts, form an "ecosystem of care" by seeking help, and collaborating to provide help to others. The study contributed key knowledge on survivors' support-seeking strategies; creating a foundational base for providers to understand survivors' safety needs and provide timely support.

Frontline GBV providers face knowledge gaps in identifying and mitigating newer, ever-evolving forms of tech violence, which becomes a deterrent for them in providing effective support to survivors. To translate the years of research on IPV into practice, I developed [In-review CSCW 2027] educational interventions to build knowledge capacity among providers across national, state, and local GBV organizations. The training programs fill these knowledge and skill gaps by providing a comprehensive understanding of tech violence, its impacts on survivors, and strategies to support them. To understand their effectiveness, we conducted evaluations through in-training discussions and through pre- and post-surveys. Training increased providers' confidence in providing support, safety planning, and referrals through community collaboration. Then, I conducted retrospective reflections through auto-ethnography to surface key lessons and tensions that emerged in designing, coordinating, and facilitating the training. Through a concrete checklist of questions, we propose a novel **design framework that future design scholars can use to build training interventions in suitable high-stakes contexts**. Moreover, I helped design *Sherloc* (awarded best paper and an honorable mention) [CSCW 2025, CHI 2026], a tool that helps tech clinic consultants capture and prepare an evidence report that survivors can use to get legal injunctions such as a restraining order or a divorce settlement. Similarly, *Lestrade* (won the CSAW applied research competition) [CCS 2025, In-review USENIX 2027], that aides clinical investigations of account compromises through a user-friendly interface that reduces friction and uncertainty among tech clinic consultants, advocates, and survivors. Finally, my grant-awarded[1] outreach efforts at MTC have resulted in 46 Zoom consultations (roughly, 25% of all consultations) with rural GBV organizations. I am currently evaluating the effectiveness of such a hybrid tech clinic service delivery model, the role of advocates in clinical investigations by situating survivors' experiences of tech violence in rural geographies and their service-seeking behaviors. My future goal is to inform research and practice towards establishing a local, sovereign, and culturally-attuned tech clinic within each organizations to scale up the tech clinic model.

2. Research Praxis to Surface and Liberate from Structural Violence. This line of work critiques the historical and ongoing role of technologies in perpetuating structural oppression, and how it manifests in and beyond bodies, ecology, and knowledge systems. This thread envisions research that critically engages with epistemic injustices, extraction baked in technology design and research, while, centering resistance and liberation from violence.

[1] Awarded $750,000 through Grant #15POVC-23-GK-01414-NONF, Office for Victims of Crime, US Department of Justice.

In the US, despite less than 3% of the population, 84.3% of Indigenous women face violence from a partner when 97% abusive partners are non-native (settler) [13]. Indigenous women are 10x more likely to be murdered than the national average [14] and represent 40% of sex trafficking victims across four sites in US and Canada [15]. However, most tribal nations cannot prosecute settler perpetrators due to lack of jurisdictional sovereignty, giving rise to an ongoing genocide called the Missing & Murdered Indigenous Relatives (MMIR) crisis. Modern technologies and infrastructure are ineffective in investigating missing persons cases, leaving most cases uncounted, unsolved, or improperly investigated. In this study [In-review CSCW 2027], I critique how infrastructure reinforce settler-colonial violence by creating "death spaces in darkness" that render Indigenous lives uncountable through bureaucratic systems instead of affording safety. To do this, I created a large-scale measurement pipeline that collected informal sources to counter the lack of Indigenous voices not being represented in academia: news articles, reports by advocates and police agencies, podcasts, and court hearings. These pages consisted of stories of missing relatives, families, advocates, and tribal police. Next, my analysis embodied value-sensitivities such as critical humility, relational accountability, and refusal. Colonial institutions use infrastructure to repeatedly misuse or appropriate Indigenous knowledge. For example, Federal databases like NamUs (only 116 (2%) cases are recorded [16]) inaccurately collect data through opaque data sharing policies among tribal, state, and federal police. Most tribes lack the agency and access to such criminal databases and are unable to release AMBER alerts. Similarly, the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP) installed five 5G cell towers along the "The Highway of Tears" to improve cell service. However, they used a narrow definition of "missing or murdered" and left out many highways with spotty cell coverage, showing clear signs of racism and ignorance. To resist, Indigenous communities mount a generational movement and reclaim infrastructure as spaces of advocacy, ceremony, memory, and care. Families, advocates, and tribal police circulate missing-person posters, coordinate search efforts, document violence, and preserve collective memory. Communities resist, refuse, reclaim, and build colonial infrastructures or create alternate infrastructure through sovereign and crowd-sourced databases, digital maps to aide search and rescue missions, culturally-sensitive support and healing to families, and social media advocacy to raise awareness of the crisis. This paper has contributed to epistemic justice in HCI by providing account of culturally-sensitive scholarship on and with Indigenous communities. We show how empirical methods can be re-imagined to critically engage with structural oppression and colonial infrastructure by centering meaning-making from the margins. I provide relational design implications towards Indigenous sovereignty and governance of data infrastructures and platforms to balance surveillance, privacy, and safety needs of the families and advocates. Moreover, I have been invited[2] to collaborate on a book chapter on MMIR. Further, I am currently working with DOJ Wisconsin MMIR Taskforce to design an intervention to support advocates with burnout, helping them automate sharing and removing posters shared on social media spaces.

Drawing on Indigenous epistemology, I connect the environmental destruction and GBV among Black and Indigenous communities. For example, the oil fracking industry in North Dakota led to a 300 percent increase in sex crimes through "Man camps", temporary housing for transient workers [17]. Similarly, BigTech companies mimic extractive industries by scaling out hyperscale AI Data Centers (DC) in rural, drought-hit, and Black and Indigenous neighborhoods. For example, in 2023, Google's DC used over 66 billion litters of water for cooling, surpassing the water use of Los Angeles for 2 weeks [18]. I challenge this AI's accelerationist narrative by examining the impacts of DC on communities who live in proximity to them. To do this, I leveraged my GBV networks to conduct ethnographic interviews with the DC resistance organizers. However, organizers highlighted the urgency of the movement as more pressing than research participation. Respecting their refusal, I instead scraped online articles, reports, podcasts that hold stories of violent impacts of DC on communities. Through this work, we show how modern extractive infrastructure disrupt relational connections with Indigenous people and nature and create conditions of harm through resource extraction, reinforcing health and economic inequities, worsening climate conditions, and limiting communities' agency and visions of the future. To fight back, communities have been leading resistance movements that refuse the privatization of their land and reclaim technologies to organize knowledge-sharing workshops, responsible land-use policies, and social media activism. This work also reimagines how sovereign and culturally-sensitive, sustainable, and sovereign AI can benefit the communities instead of accelerating inequities.

Future Agenda. Rapid scientific development of new and emerging technologies (wearables, alert systems, AI generated content) perpetuate violence among communities. I will set up a community-engaged research program to ensure that scientific development also provides safety and privacy to everyone. In short-term, I will develop interventions that helps providers detect violence early or prevent it altogether. In parallel, I will research how technologies accelerate structural violence towards marginalized communities. And in long-term, I will theorize and build safe, ethical, responsible, and sovereign technologies that dismantle structures of violence.

1. Capacity-building Interventions to Empower GBV Providers. Tech Clinics are a scarce resource that is not accessible to most survivors outside four metropolitan US cities[3]. One direction will **(a) enable frontline workers to detect GBV early**. Survivors typically fill out intake forms when they enter a hospital or shelter. Intake forms help first-responders (emergency rooms & sexual assault nurses) assess psychological, economic, and physiological safety. Embedding tech violence experiences questionnaires into the intake forms will enable providers to assess their digital

[2]Invited by University of Michigan Prof. Rebecca Irvine.

[3]There are four tech clinics in the US: CETA in New York City, MTC in Madison, TECC in Seattle, and MAVS-ETA in Arlington.

safety early that can reduce trauma and health impacts. Then, workers can utilize a layered referral system to redirect survivors to appropriate expert support providers in time. For this, I will co-develop questions and training interventions to help educate first-responders identify signs of tech violence through daily roll-call training. Secondly, I plan to signal a shift from individual safety plans towards a collectivist notion of safety, I will **(b) scale GBV providers to a peer support model** where healing happens with the community. In this model, peer support workers (PSWs) run support groups by sharing stories of violence and resilience [19]. These groups create a destigmatized space that redistributes epistemic and decision-making power, build technical skills, learn folk threat models, making safety planning less daunting for survivors. Utilizing my experience in training advocates [In-review CSCW 2027], I plan to co-design a structured program that empowers PSWs to effectively moderate and facilitate support groups. Finally, for many survivors, culturally sensitive support systems are often inaccessible. Geographic isolation leads to access barriers: lack of internet, digital literacy, resource constraints, and social barriers: cultural stigma, a close-knit community, police siding with abusers, slow justice system response. I will build a **(c) culturally-attuned tech clinic** that weighs survivors' dynamically changing cultural safety needs. This intervention will leverage the embedded knowledge infrastructure, weaving technology astuteness among the youth and generational teachings from Indigenous Elders. At MTC, we have supported 46 survivors with 15 rural organizations so far, by integrating remote consultations over Zoom in our service delivery protocol. My ongoing work evaluates the effectiveness of such an intervention model and how tech clinic consultants and rural advocates have navigated these consultations. Finally, taking my work in college context forward, I plan to work with the university health system to design educational interventions around tech violence in college campuses.

2. Surfacing and Resisting Structural Violence. My work will continue to reckon with infrastructure that perpetuate structural violence faced by marginalized communities in the Majority World (e.g., violence survivors, war refugees, incarcerated, factory & delivery workers, immigrants, unhoused, construction workers). Intergenerational trauma faced by these communities have lasting health impacts. Such negative impacts may complicate their privacy and safety needs as more essential sector technologies get digitized. For example, what does privacy mean for international students who go through social media surveillance by the Government to maintain their immigration status? Similarly, what does privacy mean for exploited factory workers in India and Kenya who watch abusive content or wear cameras to train AI robots that will soon replace them? I plan to answer these questions through intersectional theoretical lenses; such as queer [20] and black feminism [21], casteism [22], incarceration and abolition [23, 24], labor exploitation and surveillance capitalism [25, 26], refugee resettlement [27], historicism [28, 29], and infrastructure inversion [30, 31]. My projects will **(a) measure the impacts of privacy challenges faced by communities subjected to structural violence**. Importantly, to acknowledge their daily flourishing and resistance, I will build on my MMIR work and examine how **(b) communities resist, refuse, and reclaim oppressive infrastructures or build infrastructures for healing and justice movements** and how their lived experiences can inform interventions and tech policy. Recognizing culture as a vital safety condition, my work will design **(c) frameworks for cultural preservation and revitalization through technologies** through stories, knowledge, languages at-risk of extinction. Finally, collaborating with health epidemiologists and violence-prevention practitioners, I will **(d) design technological visualizations tracing the systemic health inequities** with an aim towards providing culturally-competent interventions to curb them.

3. Diverse & Inclusive AI Safety Research. Scholars have noted that computing research and interventions reflect an imperial impulse [32, 33]. However, without engaging with theories of change that center decoloniality, sovereignty, and liberation [34, 35], safety research may result in siloed privacy fixes that fail to challenge the immense power the Big Tech enterprise. For example, trust & safety teams in Big Tech companies often tout their products as private, ethical, carbon-neutral, whereas, the same companies actively harm miners who extract rare earth minerals in Congo and assemble their products in India. My computing and critical theory expertise allows me to view technologies not just as a black box, but as a combination of complex social and technical components. I will provide evidence to expand the definition of safety by tracing privacy violations in the entire lifecycle of BigTech AI systems. To do this, I will conduct a **(a) review the positionality of scholarships that underpin the digital safety research**. Is the prior work effectively addressing a variety of diverse harms and safety needs across AI abstraction layers, or, reinforcing a limited definition of online safety? Then, drawing on my workshops [HLF 2026, In-review CHI 2027, In-review DIS 2026], I plan to **(b) create a diverse and inclusive framework for AI safety** by expanding the visions of privacy and impacts of violence to situate safety in Global South and North. I will contrast how AI proliferation creates conditions of danger within communities due to the fundamental value misalignment between the corporations and communities. The framework will provide opportunities to shape AI towards a safe, sustainable, sovereign, and ethical AI.

Conclusion. To ensure that technology is safe and affirming for everyone, I build equitable sociotechnical interventions and research practices that can reduce and prevent harm among communities. In collaboration with impacted communities, I work by centering resilience, agency, and sovereignty of technologies for social good and collective well-being. I have made contributions across top-tier cross-disciplinary venues and supported more than 200 survivors and GBV frontline providers. Going forward, my research will advance safety, equity, justice, and diversity in computing, ensuring that stakeholders can reconcile and co-create towards equitable visions of the future.

My Publications

[In-review CSCW 2027] **Naman Gupta**, Connie W. Chau, Sophie Stephenson, Rahul Chatterjee, and Kate Walsh. "Lessons from Trauma-Informed Training on Technology-Facilitated Abuse for Gender-Based Violence Advocates". In: *review at CSCW* (2026). URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2610.02688.

[CSCW 2025] Sophie Stephenson, **Naman Gupta**, Akhil Polamarasetty, Kyle Huang, David Youssef, Kayleigh Cowan, and Rahul Chatterjee. "Legal Evidence of Technology-Facilitated Abuse in Wisconsin: Surfacing Barriers Within and Beyond the Courtroom." In: *Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing* 🏆 **Honorable Mention (top 5%)**. 2025. URL: https://doi.org/10.1145/3757622.

[CHI 2026] Sophie Stephenson, **Naman Gupta**, Kyle Huang, David Youssef, Kayleigh Cowan, and Rahul Chatterjee. "Trauma-Informed Digital Evidence Collection:A Design Inquiry into Evidence Practices for Technology-Facilitated Abuse in Intimate Partner Violence". In: *2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* 🏆 **Best Paper (top 1%)**. 2026. URL: https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790296.

[CCS 2025] Julia Nonnenkamp, **Naman Gupta**, Abhimanyu Dev Gupta, and Rahul Chatterjee. "Hidden in Plain Bytes: Investigating Interpersonal Account Compromise with Data Exports". In: *2025 ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security*. 2025. URL: https://doi.org/10.1145/3719027.3765147.

[In-review USENIX 2027] Julia Nonnenkamp, **Naman Gupta**, Angela Wang, Sophie Stephenson, and Rahul Chatterjee. "LEStrADE: Investigating Account Compromise using Data Exports for Survivors of Technology-Facilitated Abuse". In: *review at USENIX Security*. 2026. URL: https://naman.github.io/assets/files/papers/lestrade.pdf.

[CHI 2024] **Naman Gupta**, Sanchari Das, Kate Walsh, and Rahul Chatterjee. "A Critical Analysis of the Prevalence of Technology-Facilitated Abuse in US College Students". In: *Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024. URL: https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3652036.

[USENIX 2024] **Naman Gupta**, Kate Walsh, Sanchari Das, and Rahul Chatterjee. ""I really just leaned on my community for support": Barriers, Challenges, and Coping Mechanisms Used by Survivors of {Technology-Facilitated} Abuse to Seek Social Support". In: 2024. URL: https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.5555/3698900.3699179.

[NDSS 2024] **Naman Gupta**, Rose Ceccio, Majed Almansoori, and Rahul Chatterjee. "Analyzing the Patterns and Behavior of Users When Detecting and Preventing Tech-enabled Stalking". In: 2023. URL: https://doi.org/10/gr8rnx.

[In-review CSCW 2027] **Naman Gupta**, Sophie Stephenson, Chung Chi Yeung, Wei Ting Wu, Jeneile Luebke, Kate Walsh, and Rahul Chatterjee. ""Lighting The Way For Those Not Here": How Technology Researchers Can Help Fight the Missing and Murdered Indigenous Relatives (MMIR) Crisis". In: *review at CSCW 2027*. 2025. URL: https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2601.17966.

[HLF 2026] **Naman Gupta**. "Polycrisis in the Age of AI and Scientific Acceleration". In: 2026.

[In-review CHI 2027] **Naman Gupta**, Freddy Reiber, Jasmine C. Foriest, Ailsa Robertson, Jordan Taylor, Palak Dudani, Ghadeer Awwad, Shreya Chowdhary, David Gamba, Eugene Kim, and Katie Seaborn. "Counter-Computing: Digital Resistances and Global Solidarities". In: *Review at ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2027.

[In-review DIS 2026] Jasmine C Foriest, Alicia DeVrio, Li Qiwei, Nimra Ahmed, **Naman Gupta**, Jensine Raihan, Franchesca Spektor, and Justine Zhang. "Violence as a Boundary Object: Language, Power, and Design Justice". In: *Review at ACM DIS Designing Interactive Systems*. 2026.

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